

5-4-3-2-1 Sensory Grounding Guide

*Write your thoughts, pause, or talk to a trusted adult whenever you feel ready.
A practical worksheet for managing sudden overwhelm and anxiety*

WHAT IT FEELS LIKE

Sensory grounding helps bring your attention away from racing thoughts back into the safety of the present moment.

GROUNDING RESET

The 5-4-3-2-1 Sensory Reset

Step 1: Look for 5 things you can see. Step 2: Notice 4 things you can touch or feel physically. Step 3: Listen for 3 distinct sounds. Step 4: Identify 2 scents or aromas. Step 5: Name 1 positive thing you appreciate right now.

Take 3 slow breaths. You do not need to rush or figure everything out at once.

REPUTABLE RESOURCE & FURTHER READING

<https://www.nhs.uk/mental-health/self-help/tips-and-support/grounding-techniques/>

Visit this resource online for in-depth adolescent mental health guides and worksheets.

IMPORTANT SAFETY & EDUCATIONAL NOTICE

Heard & Healed is a supportive and educational platform designed to help young people understand their emotions, reflect on what they are experiencing, and find helpful resources. It is not a substitute for therapy, counselling, medical care, diagnosis, or professional mental-health support.

Free 24/7 Helpline: 1098 / 988 / 14416 | Website: heardandhealed.org